SOCIAL SELLING STYLES

What If You Could Read Any Buyer in the First Five Minutes?

You can — and by the end of this course, you will. Social Style Selling gives you a live, observable framework to connect with any buyer, any time.



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Where This Model Comes From

Developed by Reid and Merrill — built on observed behavior, not personality tests or labels. Two axes. Four styles. One skill set that works in every sales conversation. Your instructor is live beside this slide — ask questions anytime.



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Three Ground Rules Before We Start

- **No style is better or worse**
- All four have real strengths and real blind spots.

- **No one is a pure style**
- An adjacent style shapes and softens how the primary style shows up.

- **Style describes observable behavior only**
- It does not define the whole person.

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The Two-Axis Framework

Every style lives at the intersection of those two answers.

- **X Axis — Ask vs. Tell**
- How does this person get what they want?

- **Y Axis — Task vs. People**
- What drives their behavior?

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The Four Styles on the Grid

One grid. Four quadrants. Your job is to place the buyer before the pitch begins.

- **Driver**
- Tells, Task-focused

- **Analytical**
- Asks, Task-focused

- **Amiable**
- Asks, People-focused

- **Expressive**
- Tells, People-focused

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Quick Sort — Let's Practice

Think of someone you know well — a colleague, a manager, a customer.

- **Do they tend to tell or ask?**
- **Are they focused on tasks or people?**
- **Name the quadrant out loud to your instructor and they will confirm or redirect you.**

Quick Sort – Click to Try It

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Three Questions That Reveal Style

Those three answers will point you to a style almost every time.

- **Does this person tell or ask?**
- **How much emotion do they show — low and controlled, or high and animated?**
- **What do they seem to focus on — results, data, relationships, or vision?**

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Driver and Analytical — What to Watch For

Both styles run low on visible emotion — the task focus is what separates them.

- **Driver**
- Gives direction, decides fast, low emotion, focused on speed and outcomes.

- **Analytical**
- Asks many questions, methodical, low emotion, focused on data and accuracy, hates being caught unprepared.

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Expressive and Amiable — What to Watch For

Both styles run high on emotion — the tell vs. ask instinct is what separates them.

- **Expressive**
- Animated, storytelling, high emotion, focused on vision and big possibilities, wants to be heard.

- **Amiable**
- Soft-spoken, warm, high emotion, focused on consensus and relationships, avoids conflict and rushed decisions.

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The Signature Question — Your Live Diagnostic Signal

Hear one of these in the first minutes of a meeting and you have a strong style signal.

- **Driver asks "What?"**
- Focused on results.
- **Analytical asks "How?"**
- Focused on process and accuracy.
- **Amiable asks "Why?"**
- Focused on relationships and fit.
- **Expressive asks "Who?"**
- Focused on people and vision.

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Pressure Behaviors — When the Conversation Goes Off Track

A pressure behavior means something has broken down — it is a signal to slow down and shift.

- **Driver**
- Takes control of the meeting.

- **Analytical**
- Asks for more time and more data.

- **Expressive**
- Becomes argumentative.

- **Amiable**
- Goes quiet and withdraws.

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Mixed Signals? Blame the Adjacent Style

If a buyer does not feel like a clean fit, look one quadrant over — that is your answer.

- **Driver with an Expressive adjacent**
- Will be direct but warmer than a pure Driver.

- **Analytical with an Amiable adjacent**
- Will be methodical but more relationship-conscious.

Find the Adjacent Style

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Map a Real Prospect — Activity

Think of a current prospect or a recent customer. How did they speak?
What did they ask?
How much emotion did they show? Tell your instructor — describe what you observed out loud, and ask them to help you map that person to a style and identify their likely signature question.



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Selling to a Driver

- Plan for less time than you were given.
- Lead with conclusions and results — save the data as backup.
- Offer clear options and end with specific, actionable next steps.
- Small talk and unnecessary detail damage rapport fast.

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Selling to an Analytical

- Prepare detailed, logical questions and use evidence throughout.
- Use Guided Discovery to surface risks of the status quo and competitive alternatives.
- Allow time for evaluation — never rush, never get too personal.
- Justify your process by referencing accuracy and completeness.

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Selling to an Expressive

- Focus discovery on their perspectives, dreams, and ambitions.
- Use curiosity questions and let them elaborate fully.
- Show enthusiasm and demonstrate understanding with active listening and non-verbal cues.
- Ask who else should be involved — minimize detail-heavy conversations.

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Selling to an Amiable

- Spend real time on rapport before you talk business.
- Explain how you got to this meeting and who introduced you.
- Use "we" language throughout — present verbally and offer detailed follow-up documents.
- Never push or rush a decision. Position yourself as a stable, friendly resource.

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Your Own Style Is Part of the Equation

How you naturally sell may land very differently on a buyer of another style.
A high-Tell, low-emotion Driver rep can shut down an Amiable buyer before the conversation starts — without realizing it.
Awareness of your own defaults is the first step to adjusting them.



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Role-Play — Practice the Tactics Live

- **Choose a style you want to practice selling to.**

- **Ask your instructor to play that buyer**
- They will open with the signature question, show the typical cues, and eventually trigger a mild pressure behavior.

- **Respond with the right style-matched tactics**
- Then ask your instructor for feedback on what landed and what to adjust.

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What Versatility Actually Means

Versatility is the deliberate act of adjusting your communication approach to reduce friction and connect more effectively.
It is not about becoming someone you are not — it is about removing barriers in the relationship.
Reps with high versatility earn trusted advisor status because buyers feel understood regardless of style.



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Spotting a Mismatch Early

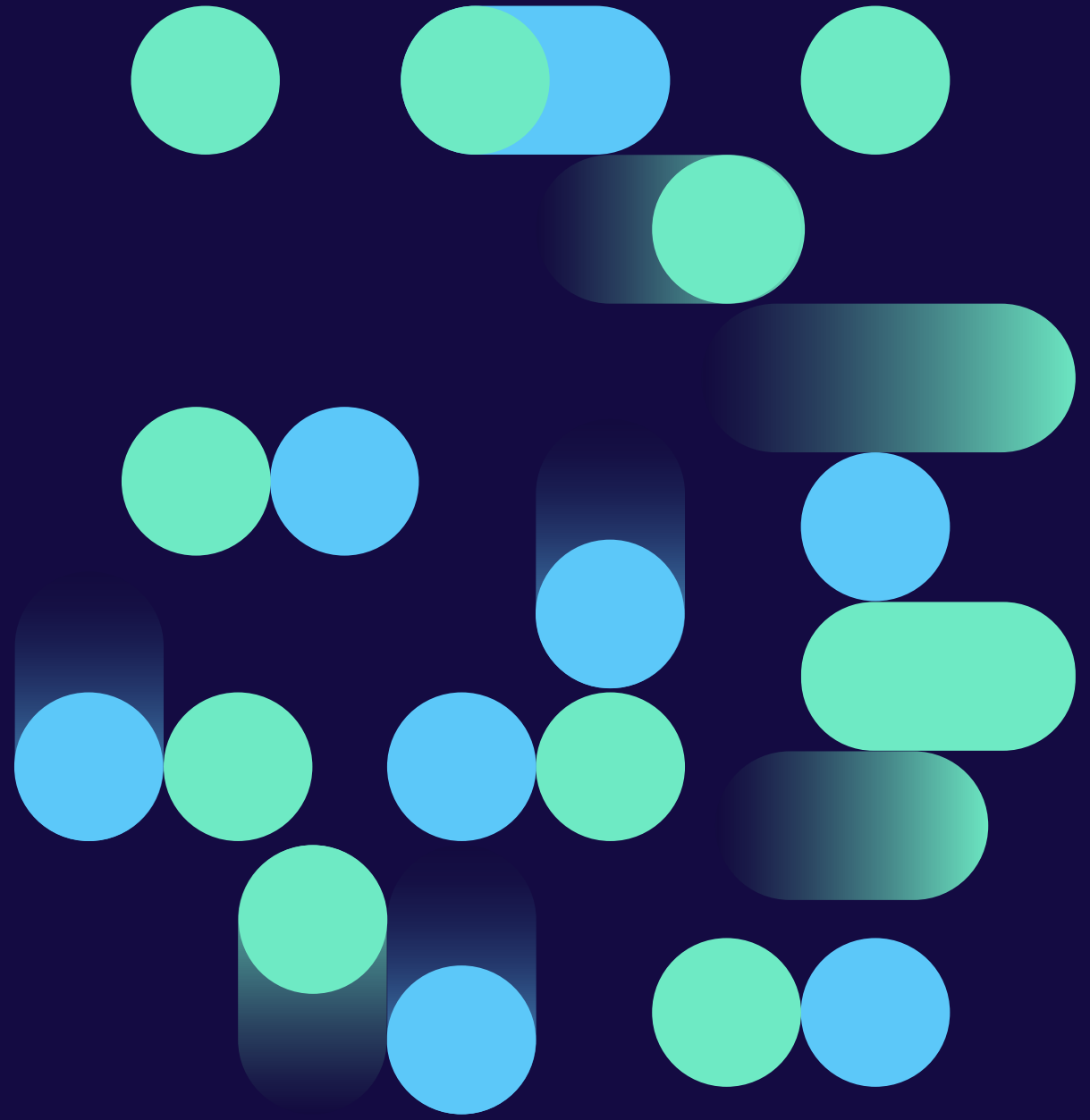
- **Catching it early**
  - Lets you shift before rapport is damaged.
- **Catching it late**
  - Means rebuilding trust you did not need to lose.

A pressure behavior or a sudden drop in engagement is your early warning signal.

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Versatility Is a Discipline, Not a Trait

You do not need a different personality for each buyer.
You need one disciplined habit: read the cues, name the style, adjust the approach.
Style is the vehicle — the destination is always the same: a meaningful, trusted relationship that leads to a sale.



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Know Your Own Style — Final Activity

- **Tell your instructor what you believe your dominant Social Style is.**
- **Describe one type of buyer you find it hardest to connect with.**
- **Ask your instructor to explain what that style mismatch looks like from the buyer's side and what one specific adjustment you can make in your very next meeting.**

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Optional Knowledge Check

A brief private quiz is available to reinforce the four styles, signature questions, pressure behaviors, and selling tactics.
Nothing is recorded. It is for your own confidence.
Ask your instructor how to access it when you are ready.



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You Now Have the Framework — Use It in Your Next Call

Try the Style Reader

Reads emails. Identifies the writer's Social Style. Drafts a response.



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